SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

6 September 2023 · Shift 2

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 42 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 1 question

Q.15

Seven people, C, F, D, K, O, L, and V are sitting in a straight line, facing south. V sits second to the right of F. Only three people sit to the right of O. K is an immediate neighbour of O and D. Only three people sit between L and V. F is not an immediate neighbour of L. Who sits to the extreme left of the line?

(A) C
(B) F
(C) V
(D) D

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

Who inaugurated the 2023 World Squash Championships that was held in India?

(A) KN Nehru
(B) K Ponmudi
(C) EV Velu
(D) Udhayanidhi Stalin

Q.3

What is ‘Mahawat’ in India?

(A) Cold waves during the winter season
(B) Cloud burst during the monsoon season
(C) Cyclonic rainfall during the winter season
(D) Hot and dry winds during the summer season

Q.5

Which Article of the Constitution of India deals with the organization of village panchayat?

(A) Article 38
(B) Article 45
(C) Article 40
(D) Article 36

Q.6

Bharati Shivaji and Kanak Rele are exponents of _____.

(A) Manipuri
(B) Mohiniyattam
(C) Kathak
(D) Odissi

Q.7

Which is the most common ore of oxidised mercury that occurs in granular crusts or veins associated with volcanic activity and hot springs?

(A) Diaspore
(B) Siderite
(C) Cinnabar
(D) Corundum

Q.8
Women's World Boxing Championship 2023 was held in which city in India?

(A) Goa
(B) Punjab
(C) New Delhi
(D) Gujarat

Q.9
Who is regarded as the ‘Mother of Indian Revolution’?

(A) Annie Besant
(B) Usha Mehta
(C) Madame Cama
(D) Kasturba Gandhi

Q.10
Which microscopic, single-celled photosynthetic organisms are known as the primary producers of the ocean - the organisms that form the base of the aquatic food chains?

(A) Phytoplankton
(B) Zooplankton
(C) Bacterioplankton
(D) Virioplankton

Q.11
Which of the following novels is correctly paired with its author?

(A) The Shadow Lines – RK Narayan
(B) Malgudi Days – Vikram Seth
(C) The Namesake – Jhumpa Lahiri
(D) Train to Pakistan – Amitav Ghosh

Q.12
Which of the following is a communication mail channel in India?

(A) Pink channel
(B) Yellow channel
(C) Red channel
(D) Green channel

Q.13
Under the umbrella of Ujjwal Bharat Ujjwal Bhavishya–Power @ 2047, the PM inaugurated which of the following 100 MW Solar Projects in Telangana?

(A) Jurala Solar Power Plant
(B) ReNew Solar Power Plant
(C) Ramagundam Floating Solar Project
(D) Dharmaraopet Solar Power Plant

Q.14
What is the name of the geographic feature that serves as a boundary between Europe and Africa?

(A) Bosporus Strait
(B) Strait of Gibraltar
(C) Dardanelles Strait
(D) Malacca Strait

Q.16
What is the primary purpose of microfinance institutions (MFIs) in India?

(A) To promote consumer spending among middle-class households
(B) To offer financial services exclusively to large businesses
(C) To provide small loans to low-income individuals
(D) To facilitate foreign investment in the Indian economy

Q.17
Which of the following is true about transfer payments in relation to personal income?

(A) Transfer payments are included in personal income.
(B) Transfer payments have no impact on personal income.
(C) Transfer payments are included in personal income only for businesses.
(D) Transfer payments are excluded from personal income.

Q.18
Who among the following reformers initially set up a school for girls in Calcutta?

(A) Narayana Guru
(B) Mahatma Phule
(C) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(D) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar

Q.19
Bharhut Stupa is located in which of the following states?

(A) Punjab
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Bihar

Q.20
The most famous of all Jain festivals, Mahamastakabhisheka is performed every 12 years at the Digambara sacred complex at _____ in Karnataka.

(A) Keelakuilkudi
(B) Jinanathapura
(C) Shravanabelagola
(D) Puliyarmala

Q.21
Which religion has the maximum number of followers in Bhutan?

(A) Hindu
(B) Islam
(C) Buddhism
(D) Christian

Q.22
The Madhavpur fair is held at _____.

(A) Bhatinda
(B) Moradabad
(C) Porbandar
(D) Jaisalmer

Q.23
The former captain of the Indian women's hockey team _____ was conferred with the BBC Lifetime Achievement Award for her contribution to Indian sports and inspiring generations of players.

(A) Rani Rampal
(B) Vandana Katariya
(C) Savita Punia
(D) Pritam Siwach

Q.24
Who among the following is a Bharatanatyam and Kathakali dancer?

(A) Padma Subrahmanayam
(B) Sonal Mansingh
(C) Shovana Narayan
(D) Mrinalini Sarabhai

Q.25
Which Article of the Constitution of India guarantees the right to move the Supreme Court for the enforcement of the fundamental rights?

(A) Article 21
(B) Article 32
(C) Article 25
(D) Article 29

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Existentialism has a reputation for being angst-ridden and gloomy mostly because of its emphasis on pondering the meaningless of existence.

(A) on pondering the meaningless of existence
(B) mostly because of its emphasis
(C) Existentialism has a reputation
(D) for being angst-ridden and gloomy

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. To “preparing the vine for plant”, it should be cut back to 2 ft.

(A) prepares in vine in plant
(B) prepare a vine in planting
(C) prepared the vine of plant
(D) prepare the vine for planting

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. The student provided her English teacher a short and _____(incoherent) account of her journey to Shimla with her parents.

(A) humble
(B) lucid
(C) rough
(D) genuine

Q.4

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. I want to / give you / an information about / the missing necklace.

(A) an information about
(B) the missing necklace
(C) give you
(D) I want to

Q.5

Identify the most appropriate meaning of the given word. Ancient

(A) Antique
(B) Unworn
(C) Contemporary
(D) Recent

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. They “are sell their company’s” products to people.

(A) are sell the company
(B) are selling their company’s
(C) was sell the company’s
(D) is selling they company’s

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. Mary is “a ball of fire” and is always engaged in something creative.

(A) An active and energetic person
(B) A dull and insipid person
(C) To be good and beneficial for someone
(D) A talkative person

Q.8

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. By living in a rural area with access to the city, she gets _____.

(A) the best of both worlds
(B) to keep an ear to the ground
(C) on cloud nine
(D) in for a penny in for a pound

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. “The cats” food bowl was empty, so he meowed incessantly until his owner finally filled it with fresh kibble.

(A) The cats’
(B) A cat’s
(C) A cats’
(D) The cat’s

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Get your act together

(A) To have patience
(B) To stay together
(C) To act in a play
(D) Get organised and do things better

Q.11

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Unpleasant

(A) Nebulous
(B) Natal
(C) Negligible
(D) Nasty

Q.12

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) The mother exclaimed / (B) when she saw her son / (C) stumble on the race track, / (D) “Look, he fells!”

(A) B
(B) D
(C) C
(D) A

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can rectify the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to rectify it, select ‘no rectification needed’. The conductor said that it was the “worse” quake he ever knew.

(A) more bad
(B) bad
(C) no rectification needed
(D) worst

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. After having invested so much time and energy into the project, we are now “back to square one”.

(A) Not ready for the consequence
(B) In the same city
(C) Fighting with each other
(D) Having to start all over again

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Killing of one’s own father

(A) Matricide
(B) Filicide
(C) Patricide
(D) Suicide

Q.16

The sentence given below has spelling errors. Select the sentence without spelling errors. Though we read and hear a lot on green initiattive, we hardly tweak our routines to suite the larger picture.

(A) Though we read and hear a lot on green initiatives, we hardly tweak our routines to suit the larger picture.
(B) Throug we read and hear a lot on green initiatives, we hardly tweak our routines to suite the larger picture.
(C) Though we read and hear a lot on green initiatives, we hardly tweek our routines to suite the larger picture.
(D) Though we read and hear a lot on green iniciatives, we hardly tweak our routines to suite the larger picture.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. The athlete’s injury was a _____(defeat) for the team’s chances of winning the championship.

(A) progression
(B) breakthrough
(C) stress
(D) setback

Q.18

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Parallel
(B) Recommend
(C) Irresistable
(D) Tomorrow

Q.19

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Millennium
(B) Milennium
(C) Millenum
(D) Milenium

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the following sentence. She proposed to write the “life history” of the famous poet.

(A) novel
(B) biography
(C) mythology
(D) autobiography

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Democracy is a form of government where the power lies _____(1) the people. It is based on the principles of equality, freedom and the rule of law. In a democratic society, _____(2) have the right to participate in the decision-making process, _____(3) directly or through elected representatives. Democracy also allows for the _____(4) of individual rights and liberties. While democracy is not without its challenges, such as the need to balance competing interests and the risk of _____(5) movements, it remains one of the most widely embraced forms of government around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) towards
(B) on
(C) by
(D) with

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Democracy is a form of government where the power lies _____(1) the people. It is based on the principles of equality, freedom and the rule of law. In a democratic society, _____(2) have the right to participate in the decision-making process, _____(3) directly or through elected representatives. Democracy also allows for the _____(4) of individual rights and liberties. While democracy is not without its challenges, such as the need to balance competing interests and the risk of _____(5) movements, it remains one of the most widely embraced forms of government around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) lawyers
(B) humans
(C) politicians
(D) citizens

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Democracy is a form of government where the power lies _____(1) the people. It is based on the principles of equality, freedom and the rule of law. In a democratic society, _____(2) have the right to participate in the decision-making process, _____(3) directly or through elected representatives. Democracy also allows for the _____(4) of individual rights and liberties. While democracy is not without its challenges, such as the need to balance competing interests and the risk of _____(5) movements, it remains one of the most widely embraced forms of government around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) either
(B) however
(C) neither
(D) also

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Democracy is a form of government where the power lies _____(1) the people. It is based on the principles of equality, freedom and the rule of law. In a democratic society, _____(2) have the right to participate in the decision-making process, _____(3) directly or through elected representatives. Democracy also allows for the _____(4) of individual rights and liberties. While democracy is not without its challenges, such as the need to balance competing interests and the risk of _____(5) movements, it remains one of the most widely embraced forms of government around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) delimitation
(B) protection
(C) diversion
(D) proscription

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Democracy is a form of government where the power lies _____(1) the people. It is based on the principles of equality, freedom and the rule of law. In a democratic society, _____(2) have the right to participate in the decision-making process, _____(3) directly or through elected representatives. Democracy also allows for the _____(4) of individual rights and liberties. While democracy is not without its challenges, such as the need to balance competing interests and the risk of _____(5) movements, it remains one of the most widely embraced forms of government around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) marginal
(B) elitist
(C) populist
(D) negligible

Answer key

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.15 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**
Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**		

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.15 · Answer (B) F

Numbering the seats 1 to 7 from the left end (the people's own left): three people sit to O's right, so O is in seat 4, and K sits between O and D. With K in 3 and D in 2, V (second to F's right) could only be in 7, leaving no seat four away for L; so K is in 5 and D in 6. Then F is in 1, V in 3, L in 7 and C in 2: F, C, V, O, K, D, L, with F at the extreme left.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Udhayanidhi Stalin

The squash event India hosted in 2023, the Squash World Cup in Chennai in June, was declared open by Udhayanidhi Stalin, then Tamil Nadu's Minister for Youth Welfare and Sports Development. K. N. Nehru, K. Ponmudi and E. V. Velu were also Tamil Nadu ministers at the time.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Cyclonic rainfall during the winter season

Mahawat is the light winter rain that western disturbances, cyclones from the Mediterranean region, bring to north-west India; it is small in amount but valuable for the rabi crops.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Article 40

Article 40, a Directive Principle, directs the State to organise village panchayats and give them the powers they need to work as units of self-government. Article 38 is on the social order, 45 on early childhood care and education, and 36 defines 'the State' for Part IV.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Mohiniyattam

Bharati Shivaji and Kanak Rele are noted exponents of Mohiniyattam, the classical dance of Kerala.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Cinnabar

Cinnabar, mercury(II) sulphide (HgS), in which mercury is in its oxidised +2 state, is the chief ore of mercury and forms crusts and veins near volcanic activity and hot springs. It is the only mercury mineral among the options: diaspore and corundum are aluminium minerals and siderite is iron carbonate.

Q.8 · Answer (C) New Delhi

The 2023 IBA Women's World Boxing Championships were held in New Delhi in March 2023, and Indian boxers won four gold medals there.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Madame Cama

Bhikaji Rustom Cama (Madame Cama), who unfurled an early Indian national flag at the International Socialist Congress in Stuttgart in 1907, is called the 'Mother of Indian Revolution'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Phytoplankton

Phytoplankton, microscopic photosynthetic organisms such as diatoms, are the ocean's primary producers. Zooplankton are animals that feed on them, and bacterioplankton and virioplankton are bacteria and viruses.

Q.11 · Answer (C) The Namesake – Jhumpa Lahiri

'The Namesake' (2003) is by Jhumpa Lahiri. 'The Shadow Lines' is Amitav Ghosh's, 'Malgudi Days' R. K. Narayan's and 'Train to Pakistan' Khushwant Singh's.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Green channel

NCERT lists six mail channels introduced for quicker delivery in large towns and cities: Rajdhani, Metro, Green, Business, Bulk Mail and Periodical. There is no pink, yellow or red channel among them.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Ramagundam Floating Solar Project

At the 'Ujjwal Bharat Ujjwal Bhavishya - Power @2047' event on 30 July 2022, the Prime Minister dedicated NTPC's 100 MW Ramagundam floating solar project in Telangana to the nation, along with the 92 MW Kayamkulam floating solar project in Kerala.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Strait of Gibraltar
The Strait of Gibraltar separates Spain in Europe from Morocco in Africa and joins the Mediterranean to the Atlantic. The Bosporus and the Dardanelles divide Europe from Asia, and the Strait of Malacca lies between the Malay Peninsula and Sumatra.

Q.16 · Answer (C) To provide small loans to low-income individuals
Microfinance institutions give small loans, and often savings and insurance, to low-income people who lack access to ordinary banking.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Transfer payments are included in personal income.
Personal income is the income households actually receive, so transfer payments such as pensions, scholarships and unemployment allowances are added to it, although they are not part of national income.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar led girls' education in Bengal: he was secretary of the Bethune School, the girls' school founded in Calcutta in 1849, and opened about 35 girls' schools across Bengal in the 1850s. Jyotirao Phule's first girls' school was in Pune (1848).

Q.19 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
The Bharhut stupa, known for its carved railings and gateways of the Shunga period (2nd century BCE), is in Satna district of Madhya Pradesh; many of its sculptures are now in the Indian Museum, Kolkata.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Shravanabelagola
The Mahamastakabhisheka, the anointing of the colossal statue of Bahubali (Gommateshwara), is held about every 12 years at Shravanabelagola in Hassan district, Karnataka.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Buddhism
About three-quarters of Bhutan's people follow Buddhism, mainly of the Vajrayana (Tibetan) tradition; Hindus, living largely in the south, are the largest minority.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Porbandar
The Madhavpur Ghed fair, held around Ram Navami at Madhavpur in Porbandar district, Gujarat, celebrates the marriage of Krishna and Rukmini.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Pritam Siwach
Pritam Siwach, a former captain of India's women's hockey team, received the BBC Lifetime Achievement Award for 2022 at the BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year awards in March 2023.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Mrinalini Sarabhai
Mrinalini Sarabhai trained in both Bharatanatyam and Kathakali and founded the Darpana Academy in Ahmedabad. Padma Subrahmanyam is a Bharatanatyam dancer, Sonal Mansingh is known for Bharatanatyam and Odissi, and Shovana Narayan for Kathak.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Article 32
Article 32 gives the right to move the Supreme Court for the enforcement of the Fundamental Rights; Ambedkar called it the 'heart and soul' of the Constitution. Article 21 protects life and personal liberty, 25 freedom of religion and 29 the interests of minorities.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) on pondering the meaningless of existence
After 'the' a noun is needed: 'the meaninglessness of existence'. 'Meaningless' is an adjective.

Q.2 · Answer (D) prepare the vine for planting
Purpose is shown by the infinitive, 'to' with the base form, and a preposition takes the gerund: 'To prepare the vine for planting, it should be cut back to 2 ft.'

Q.3 · Answer (B) lucid
'Incoherent' means muddled and hard to follow; its opposite is 'lucid', clear and easy to understand.

Q.4 · Answer (A) an information about
'Information' is an uncountable noun and takes no 'an': 'give you some information about the missing necklace'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Antique
'Ancient' means very old, as does 'antique'; 'contemporary' and 'recent' are its opposites.

Q.6 · Answer (B) are selling their company's
The present continuous is 'are' with the '-ing' form: 'They are selling their company's products to people.'

Q.7 · Answer (A) An active and energetic person
A 'ball of fire' is a lively, energetic person.

Q.8 · Answer (A) the best of both worlds
To get 'the best of both worlds' is to enjoy the advantages of two different things at once, here country living and the city.

Q.9 · Answer (D) The cat's
One particular cat ('he meowed', 'his owner') owns the bowl, so the singular possessive with 'the' is needed: 'The cat's food bowl'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Get organised and do things better
To 'get your act together' is to get organised and start doing things properly.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Nasty
'Nasty' means unpleasant. 'Nebulous' means vague, 'natal' relates to birth, and 'negligible' means too small to matter.

Q.12 · Answer (B) D
'Fell' is the past tense of 'fall', and 'fells' belongs to another verb, to fell (cut down) a tree; the mother needs the present of 'fall': 'Look, he falls' or 'he is falling'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) worst
'The' and 'he ever knew' compare it with every quake he knew, so the superlative is needed: 'the worst quake he ever knew'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Having to start all over again
To be 'back to square one' is to have to start again from the beginning after making no progress.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Patricide
'Patricide' is the killing of one's own father; matricide is of one's mother, filicide of one's child, and suicide of oneself.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Though we read and hear a lot on green initiatives, we hardly tweak our routines to suit the larger picture.
The correct spellings are 'though', 'initiatives', 'tweak' and 'suit' (to fit); a 'suite' is a set of rooms or things.

Q.17 · Answer (D) setback
A 'setback' is a reverse that holds back progress, close in sense to 'defeat' here; 'progression' and 'breakthrough' point the other way.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Irresistable
The correct spelling is 'irresistible'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Millennium
The correct spelling is 'millennium', with a double 'l' and a double 'n'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) biography
A 'biography' is the story of a person's life written by someone else; an autobiography is written by the person themselves.

Q.21 · Answer (D) with
Power 'lies with' the people: it belongs to them.

Q.22 · Answer (D) citizens
In a democracy it is the 'citizens', the members of the state, who have the right to take part in its decisions.

Q.23 · Answer (A) either
'Either ... or' joins the two ways of taking part: 'either directly or through elected representatives'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) protection
Democracy allows for the 'protection' of rights and liberties; 'proscription' means banning and 'delimitation' fixing boundaries.

Q.25 · Answer (C) populist
'Populist' movements, which claim to speak for ordinary people against an elite, are a familiar risk to democracies; 'marginal' or 'negligible' movements would pose little risk.

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